

A dispute we promote

Pursuing the case for *your* rights as a consumer

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It's quite unfortunate that in today's consumer-driven economy, most of us face problems. Be it as vague as mobile phone hanging for no reason, or as specific as delivery of wrong motherboards. It's commonplace for vendors to sell a different product to customers, falsely assuring them of similar performance.

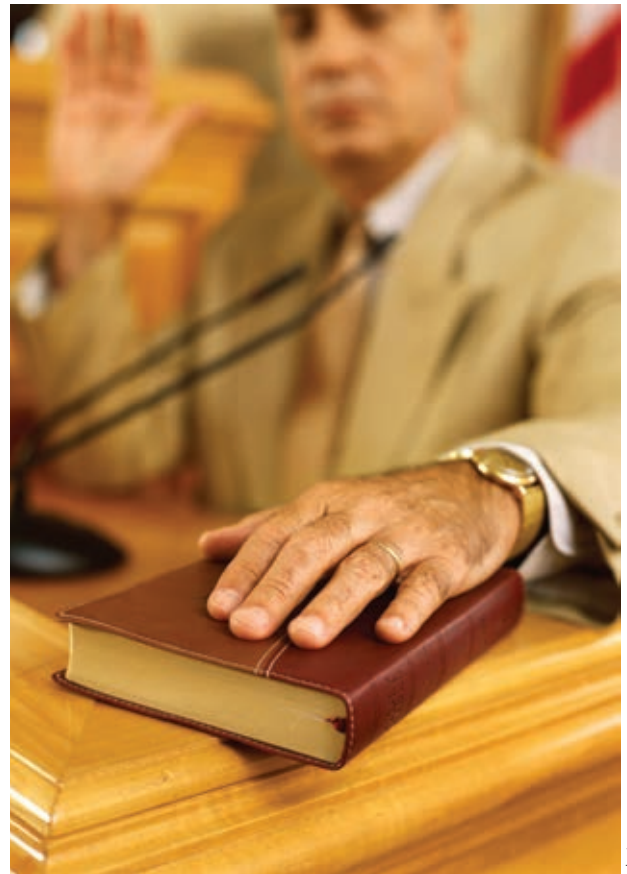
In fact, it is found to be happening more often in product categories such as graphics cards where performance levels vary from one vendor to another despite the same chipset, or in some cases, even processors. It is very easy to misguide naïve customers and sell them a lower clock speed processor considering that

sumer's decision is based on what the company and the seller states (or advertises) about the product. A good example is that of the speaker systems that rate their output in terms of PMPO, which is misleading. RMS ratings are a better indication of the audio level capabilities of speakers.



The rapid growth in the sales of IT peripherals and electronic goods, coupled with strict consumer laws has led to a further rise in consumer rights petitions in India. There are a few points you must adhere to, in order to stay secure.

- Always retain your receipt safely.
- If any warranty/guarantee card comes along, ask the seller to fill it properly.
- Keep monthly bills and receipts of all payments you make safely.
- Report all defects in the product to the manufacturer as well as the seller.
- A written letter should always be given to the company to replace or repair the defective product before filing a consumer complaint. Telephonic conversations or verbal assurances must be avoided.
- Never give original documents to



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anyone except the consumer forum or court.

- The case must be filed within two years of the occurrence of the problem.
- A few reasons for failure in a consumer case include reluctance on the part of the consumer to maintain records or go to the consumer forum when the case was listed. The general defence maintained by companies in most cases are very limited: that the consumer never informed about the defect or the defect is because of product misuse. In fact, most of the disputes are settled by companies much before they go to consumer forum.

The path is finally looking bright in India. There seems to be a lot of changes already in place in terms of law. Consumer forums are meant to support consumers and will do everything to support them. All that is needed from a consumer is the will to stand up for basic rights endowed on them by law. The rest should be left to the consumer forum to decide.

(For details about consumer laws visit: <http://www.ncdrn.nic.in/>) 



We can help!

If you're facing a problem with your purchase, write to us at help@consumermate.com

processors available today come in several makes and models.

If a consumer has paid hard-earned money, then he/she has a right to get a good, defect-free product. The product must be properly functional. To sum it up, it should do what it is meant to do. It is also the duty of the companies (as well as the seller) to give true information about their products, because the con-